Did Tribute Fund the Parthenon? Kallet-Marx, Lisa Classical Antiquity; Oct 1, 1989; 8, 2; ProQuest pg. 252

LISA KALLET-MARX

Did Tribute Fund the Parthenon?

IT IS CONSIDERED a fact today that the Parthenon was financed almost entirely from the tribute of Athens' allies.[1] The genesis of this view is the famous anecdote preserved in Plutarch, *Perikles* 12, on the debate between Perikles and his rivals over the financing of the building program, from which scholars have universally inferred that significant amounts of tribute were used. All other relevant and supporting evidence on Athens' building program, chiefly the building accounts of the Parthenon, *IG* I³ 436–51, has been made to conform to this view. More than reconstructions of Athenian financial history are involved in this matter; at issue as well is our assessment of Athens' perception and use of her imperial position

1. E.g., G. H. Stevenson, "The Financial Administration of Pericles," *JHS* 44 (1924) 7–8; H. T. Wade-Gery, "Thucydides the Son of Melesias," *JHS* 52 (1932) 222–23 (= *Essays in Greek History* [Oxford, 1958] 262–64); B. D. Meritt, "Indirect Tradition in Thucydides," *Hesperia* 23 (1954) 210–11; H. T. Wade-Gery and B. D. Meritt, "Athenian Resources in 449 and 431 B.C.," *Hesperia* 26 (1957) 197; R. Meiggs, "The Crisis of Athenian Imperialism," *HSCP* 67 (1963) 14; cf. also "The Political Implications of the Parthenon," *G&R*, Supplement 10 (1963), 43; *The Athenian Empire* (Oxford, 1972) 154–55 (referred to hereafter as *AE*); A. Andrewes, *The Greeks* (New York, 1967) 156; N. G. L. Hammond, *The Classical Age of Greece* (London, 1975) 161; S. Hornblower, *The Greek World 479–323 B.C.* (London, 1983); J. M. Balcer, *Sparda by the Bitter Sea* (Chico, Calif., 1984) 395; E. Kluwe, "Die athenische Geldwirtschaft im 5. Jahrhundert und die Finanzierungsweise des Parthenon," in E. Berger, ed., *Parthenon-Kongress Basel* I (Mainz, 1984) 11–12; A. E. Raubitschek, "Die historisch-politische Bedeutung des Parthenon und seines Skulpturenschmuckes," in Berger, ed., I.19; W. Schuller, "Der attische Seebund und der Parthenon," in Berger, ed., I 20–22; R. K. Unz, "The Chronology of the Pentekontaetia," *CQ*, n.s., 36 (1986) 81; implicit in M. F. McGregor, *The Athenians and Their Empire* (Vancouver, 1987) 96–97. Cf. also the acceptance of this view in specific works on the Parthenon: e.g., M. Robertson, *The Parthenon Frieze* (London, 1975) 4; S. Woodford, *The Parthenon* (Cambridge, 1981) 8; J. Boardman, *The Parthenon and Its Sculptures* (London, 1985) 26.

© 1989 BY THE REGENTS OF THE UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

and of the Parthenon's significance to the Athenian empire. The belief that allied tribute was the chief source of income for the Parthenon's construction, however, rests to a large extent not on any firm evidence, but rather on an array of assumptions based on documents whose relevance is problematic and on a literary source whose significance has, in my opinion, been misunderstood. I therefore propose to reexamine the grounds for the view that tribute comprised the primary financial source for the Parthenon's construction. This will entail, first, an investigation of the fundamental hypothesis on which this view depends, namely, that the treasurers of Athena, not the Hellenotamiai, controlled the annual tribute surplus of the Delian League as well as the total reserve; and second, an examination of the combined evidence of Plutarch, *Perikles* 12.2, and the Parthenon building accounts.

The evolution of the notion that tribute chiefly funded the Parthenon is worth summarizing at the outset. Plutarch (*Per.* 12.2) relates the story in which Perikles is accused of squandering the allies' money on sacred buildings; more than anything else, the biographer notes, the construction of ἀναθήματα irritated his enemies. This passage has always led scholars to suppose that a significant portion of tribute was used to construct the Parthenon.[2] But with the publication of the collected fragments of the Parthenon building accounts by W. B. Dinsmoor in 1913, a surprising fact emerged: the chief source of income was the treasury of Athena, while the Hellenotamiai made a smaller contribution only five times in the preserved accounts of the temple's construction over a period of fifteen years.[3] Dinsmoor, in his initial publication of the inscriptions, believed that the money from the Hellenotamiai was actually the year's *aparchē* and therefore "that the accusations by Thucydides, son of Melesias, were unfounded, a fact which would account for the victory of Pericles."[4] H. T. Wade-Gery, however, proposed in 1932 the hypothesis that became the standard view.[5] He agreed that if only the *aparchē* had been spent on the Parthenon, then the slander against Perikles was indeed unfair, but argued that the *aparchē* paid to Athena could hardly be considered "money πρὸς τὸν πόλεμον" (Plut. *Per.* 12.2).[6] He suggested rather that the tribute to which Perikles' enemies alluded was actually a much larger amount contained in the treasury of Athena,[7] a hypothesis adopted

2. E.g., E. Meyer, *Forschungen zur alten Geschichte* II (Halle, 1899) 99; A. Furtwängler, *Masterpieces of Greek Sculpture* (London, 1895) 424.

3. W. B. Dinsmoor, "Attic Building Accounts I," *AJA* 17 (1913) 53–80; in year 4, 444/3 (*IG* I^3 439, lines 72–73); year 5, 443/2 (*IG* I^3 440, lines 124–25); year 7, 441/0 (*IG* I^3 442, lines 179–80); year 9, 439/8 (*IG* I^3 444, lines 247–48); year 10, 438/7 (*IG* I^3 445, lines 292–93). In years 7 and 9, the word *h*ελλενοταμίαι is completely restored. One should note, however, that the Hellenotamiai may have contributed more often than the extant accounts indicate, since the latter are so poorly preserved for many years.

4. *Supra* n. 3, 65.

5. *Supra* n. 1 (1932).

6. Ibid. 223.

7. This view depends ultimately on the suggestion of G. H. Stevenson (*supra* n. 1, 1–9) that, since 454, the tribute surplus had been merged with the treasury of Athena.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

with considerable elaboration in *The Athenian Tribute Quota Lists*.[8] In this way, Plutarch's account was vindicated. How well supported is this hypothesis?

THE TRIBUTE SURPLUS AND THE TREASURY OF ATHENA

It will be useful to begin by establishing the chief components and consequences of the view that the allied reserve supplemented by annual deposits of tribute formed part of Athena's treasury. They are as follows: beginning in 448 the Hellenotamiai made an annual "grant" of 200 talents to the treasury of Athena, which was additional to the *aparchē* accorded the goddess from each year's tribute. This procedure was maintained until 434, when a final 200-talent deposit to Athena's treasury had brought the total to 3,000 talents—the objective, on this view. The money was not simply safeguarded in Athena's treasury (and therefore kept separate from the property of the goddess); rather it belonged to Athena, and was integrated with her treasure. One consequence of these grants was that, from 448 through 434, the Hellenotamiai had no reserves of their own, as the sum of 200 talents was supposed to reflect an actual average surplus after the normal annual operating expenses of the League had been calculated. Therefore, if any League emergency arose, the Hellenotamiai would be unable to meet the expense.[9]

This reconstruction, whereby a tribute surplus of 200 talents per annum was merged with the treasury of Athena, depends chiefly upon interpretations of three documents: the so-called Papyrus Decree (Strasbourg Papyrus Graeca 84: Anonymus Argentinensis), the financial decrees of Kallias (*IG* I³ 52), and the inscription recording Athenian expenses for the expedition against Samos in 440 (*IG* I³ 363). Let us now consider the strength of their support.

THE PAPYRUS DECREE

The Papyrus Decree has been restored variously since its publication in 1901 by B. Keil.[10] A comprehensive examination of the document was made by Wade-Gery and Meritt in 1957, and it is their final interpretation of the relevant sections that we shall now address.[11] I print lines 3–9 of their text with restorations:

3 [. . . . . Ὅτι ὠικοδόμησαν τὰ Προπύλαι]α καὶ τὸν Παρθ-
ενῶνα. μετ' ἔτη τρι-
4 [άκοντα μάλιστα ταῦτα ὕστερον τῶν Μηδι]κῶν ἤρξαντο
οἰκοδο[με]ῖν, ἐποι-

8. B. D. Meritt, H. T. Wade-Gery, M. F. McGregor, *The Athenian Tribute Lists* III (Princeton, N.J., 1950) 326–32 (referred to hereafter as *ATL*).

9. *Supra* n. 8, 327–29.

10. B. Keil, *Anonymus Argentinensis* (Strassburg, 1901); U. Wilcken, "Der Anonymus Argentinensis," *Hermes* 42 (1907) 374–418.

11. Wade-Gery and Meritt (*supra* n. 1) 163–97; cf. R. Sealey, "P. Strassburg 84 Verso," *Hermes* 86 (1958) 440–46.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

5 [ἡσαντο δ' ἀπὸ τῶν φόρων εἰπόντος ἐπ' Εὐ]θυδήμου Περικλέους γνώμη[ν] ε̣ἰ̣ς
6 [τὰ Παναθήναια ἀνενεγκεῖν τῆι 'Αθηνᾶι] τὰ ἐν δημοσί<ωι> ἀποκείμενα τάλαν-
7 [τα ἅπερ συνηγμένα παρὰ τῶν πόλεων ἧν πε]ντακισχείλια κατὰ τὴν 'Αριστε̣ί̣-
8 [δου τάξιν καὶ ἄλλα τρισχείλια ἀναφέρ]ειν εἰς τὴν πόλιν μετ' ἐκεῖνο γι̣νο-
9 [μένων τῶν ἔργων· . . . . . .]

Wade-Gery and Meritt restored the provisions as follows: 5,000 talents of tribute surplus were to be placed in the treasury of Athena; an additional 3,000 talents were also to be deposited in the treasury of Athena while the building program was being carried out. R. Meiggs summarizes the results of these restorations: "The neatness of these restorations is extremely attractive. The 3,000 talents will be those referred to in the first decree of Callias (ML 58 A.33). The 5,000 + 3,000 will be the 8,000 talents referred to in the sources (Diod. xii.38.2; Isocr. viii.126) and the 3,000 will be composed of fifteen annual contributions of 200 talents implied in the second decree of Callias (ML 58 B.22)."[12] Wade-Gery and Meritt dated the decree to 450/49, assuming the same mistake in the archon's name that Diodoros is known to have made: Euthydemos (431/0) instead of Euthynos (450/49).[13]

These restorations and the proposed connection between the several epigraphic and literary sources are, as Meiggs observes, extremely tidy; whether they are correct is an entirely different matter, and one that perhaps cannot ever be proved or disproved. But what concerns us here is whether documents whose interpretation depends almost solely on restoration should be the basis for a large-scale reconstruction of financial history with broad political significance. The Papyrus Decree is heavily restored, yet, as Meiggs notes, the line length is not secure, and restorations are awkward in places.[14] Mention of 3,000 talents in the papyrus is entirely restored, as is reference to Athena (i.e., her treasury). Finally, we cannot be sure that Euthydemos is a corruption for Euthynos. Diodoros's confusion of the two names does not prove that the same situation applies here, although it is certainly possible. There is reference to 5,000 talents of tribute, but more than that is uncertain.[15]

But there is a further and more disturbing objection. If the restorations and

12. *AE* (*supra* n. 1) 517.
13. As Keil originally suggested (*supra* n. 10).
14. *AE* (*supra* n. 1) 517–18; cf. also Sealey (*supra* n. 11).
15. It is possible that 5,000 talents of tribute were to be brought to the Akropolis, thus restoring [ἀναφέρ]ειν before εἰς τὴν πόλιν in line 7, as do Wade-Gery and Meritt; this of course does not mean that they were to be placed in Athena's treasury. Where the funds in the possession of the Hellenotamiai were kept is a puzzle, but it is reasonable to suppose a location on the Akropolis. I am not convinced, given the degree of uncertainty in line length and restoration, that there is a necessary connection between the 5,000 talents and the reference to the Propylaia and the Parthenon in the lemma heading of line 3.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

interpretation are correct, that 5,000 talents are to be brought up to the Akropolis for use on the building program, then it remains to be explained why other sources of income were necessary for the construction of the Parthenon and the Propylaia; on any estimate, that sum would have been more than adequate by itself for the building program as a whole.[16]

Because of the problematic nature of the restorations, interpretation, and date of the Papyrus Decree, one can consider it neither firm evidence nor convincing support for any historical reconstruction, since vital details are restored and the interpretation is exceedingly speculative. Furthermore, the use of the Papyrus Decree for the hypothesis that tribute surplus was handed over to the treasury of Athena annually from 448 to 434 in turn depends on another equally problematic document, which we need now to consider.

THE FINANCIAL DECREES OF KALLIAS, *IG* I³ 52

Certain provisions in Kallias's proposal in Decree A and a reference to 200 talents in Decree B are believed to provide evidence that the Hellenotamiai gave 200 talents annually to the treasury of Athena to a total of 3,000 talents, thus supporting the restoration of 3,000 talents in the Papyrus Decree. Let us first examine the relevant lines in Decrees A and B.

Decree A, lines 2–7

2 ἀποδο͡ναι τοῖς θεοῖς
3 [τ]ὰ χρέματα τὰ ὀφελόμενα, ἐπειδὲ τεῖ 'Αθεναίαι τὰ τρισχίλια τάλαντ-
4 [α] ἀνενένενγκται ἐς πόλιν, *h*ὰ ἐφσέφιστο, νομίσματος *h*εμεδαπο͡. ἀποδι-
5 [δ]όναι δὲ ἀπὸ το͡ν χρεμάτον, ἃ ἐς ἀπόδοσίν ἐστιν τοῖς θεοῖς ἐφσεφισμ-
6 [έ]να, τά τε παρὰ τοῖς ἑλλενοταμίαις ὄντα νῦν καὶ τἆλλα ἅ ἐστι τούτον
7 [το͡]ν χρεμάτον, καὶ τὰ ἐκ τε͡ς δεκάτες ἐπειδὰν πραθε͡ι.

Decree B, lines 19–23

19 [θε]-
20 [οῖς δὲ πᾶσ]ι̣ν̣ κατατιθέναι κ[ατὰ τὸ]ν ἐνιαυτὸν τὰ *h*εκά[στοι ὀφελο]-
21 [μενα παρὰ τ]ο̣ῖς ταμίασι το͡ν [τε͡ς 'Αθ]εναίας τὸς ἑλλενο[ταμίας· ἐπε]-
22 [ιδὰν δ' ἀπὸ] τ̣[ο͡]ν διακοσίον τα[λάντο]ν *h*ὰ ἐς ἀπόδοσιν ἐφ[σεφίσατο *h*]-
23 [ο δε͡μος τοῖ]ς ἄλλοις θεοῖς ἀ[ποδοθ]ε͡ι τὰ ὀφελόμενα, . . .]

16. Cf. among others, W. Schuller (*supra* n. 1, 22), who treats as fact that the contents of the League treasury were placed in Athena's treasury upon removal to Athens from Delos, but does not recognize this problem.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

According to Meritt, Wade-Gery, and M. F. McGregor, "Inasmuch as the hellenotamiai, and they alone, are named the paymasters of the repayment (ἀπόδοσις) in D2 [Decree B], line 21, it follows that they controlled the sums described in D1 [Decree A], lines 6–7, as the source of the payments, including the tithe (dekate). . . . Furthermore, since the completion of the transfer of 3,000 talents to Athena was made the condition for putting into effect the decree authorizing 200 talents, already voted, to be used for the Other Gods, it follows that the 3,000 talents must have come also from this source."[17] The authors of *ATL* ask when and how the Hellenotamiai could have had 3,000 talents, note that they did not have reserves in 449 (on their interpretation of the Papyrus Decree), nor in 441/0 either (an inference from *IG* I³ 363, the inscription recording the expenses of the Samian operation, on which see below), and they conjecture that "from 448 the estimated reserves, at the rate of 200 talents a year, were being contributed systematically to the chest of the treasurers of Athena."[18]

There are serious difficulties presented by these inferences as well as by the overall interpretation, which have not been appreciated. First, the Hellenotamiai are not named as the paymasters of the ἀπόδοσις in Decree B, lines 21–23. Rather, this is assumed from their appearance in the preceding clause (lines 20–21). In this latter section, the preserved portions seem to indicate that the Hellenotamiai are to make yearly deposits with(?) the treasurers of Athena.[19] The subsequent clause concerns repayment of debts to the Other Gods, an apparent precondition for implementing the arrangements to house separately the sacred treasures of Athena and the Other Gods. A connection between the two clauses such as the authors of *ATL* suppose and indeed restore[20] is lacking. In one, an annual regular deposit by the Hellenotamiai to Athena is envisioned, and in the other, reference is made to a one-time repayment of a debt to the Other Gods. Therefore it does not follow that the Hellenotamiai have control of the 200 talents voted for repayment in lines 22–23. This weakens in turn the support for the hypothesis of 200-talent increments of tribute to the treasury of Athena that the editors of *ATL* seem to derive from these lines in Decree B.

Second, in Decree A there is no suggestion that the Hellenotamiai are

17. *ATL* (*supra* n. 8) 326–27.

18. Ibid. 327.

19. As restored, however, the Hellenotamiai are to deposit annually money owed to "all the Gods" with the treasurers of Athena. This makes little sense in light of the arrangement in Decree A for the establishment of the board of treasurers of "the Gods" and the instructions to them for controlling and administering the funds of "the Gods" (A, lines 13–24). One could imagine some kind of interim arrangement whereby moneys belonging to the Other Gods were temporarily to be repaid to the treasury of Athena, but ἐνιαυτόν in line 20 excludes this possibility. Clearly what is being directed here is a regular procedure for the indefinite future.

20. [θεοῖς δὲ πᾶσ]ιν and ὀφελόμενα in lines 19–20 and 20–21.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

responsible for money other than what they control in line 6.[21] Finally, it is clearly a *non sequitur* to say that since the repayment directed in A to "the Gods" has as a precondition the payment of 3,000 talents to Athena, the particular source of both is the same. The authors of *ATL* offer no reason why repayment could not have been made out of any of the sources of revenue and capital reserve available to the state at that time, e.g., the *dekatē*,[22] taxes, rents and fines, or other funds in the *dēmosion* or the sacred treasuries. The sources of public money were diverse, and there is no warrant to assume that the Hellenotamiai were virtually the only possible paymasters.

There is, therefore, no evidence that the Hellenotamiai are the source of the 3,000 talents of Athena, and accordingly the need to construct an elaborate scheme to arrive at 3,000 talents in fifteen payments of 200 talents vanishes. Moreover, despite assertions to the contrary, neither is the date of the Kallias Decrees secure, nor is it certain that Decree A and Decree B were passed at the same assembly meeting and therefore belong together.[23] This too has important consequences for the hypothesis under scrutiny here. For if, as is likely, Kallias Decree A does not date to the year 434/3, the entire supposition of a 3,000-talent grant to Athena composed of fifteen annual payments of surplus tribute starting in 448 and ending in 434 loses its foundation.

Let us sum up briefly the results of our examination of the Papyrus Decree and the Kallias Decrees. We are left at this point with very little to commend Wade-Gery's view: the Papyrus Decree does not refer to the necessary 3,000 talents or the treasury of Athena, and the relevant lemma may not even refer to a decree of 450/49. In short, there is no evidence that the Papyrus Decree contains the proposal to initiate a 3,000-talent grant of tribute to Athena in 450. On the other end, that is, upon the supposed completion of this grant for which the Kallias Decrees are thought to provide evidence, there is no indication that the 3,000 talents brought to the Akropolis for Athena were comprised necessar-

21. They are only certainly responsible for τά τε παρὰ τοῖς ἑλλενοταμίαις ὄντα νῦν. It is not at all clear that they are responsible for τἆλλα ἅ ἐστι τούτον [τῶ]ν χρεμάτον, καὶ τὰ ἐκ τῆς δεκάτες ἐπειδὰν πραθῆι (lines 6–7), as the editors of *ATL* think (*supra* n. 8, 327). Rather, the clause detailing the sources of the money voted for repayment reads most naturally if one supposes that the Hellenotamiai have control only of τὰ τε παρὰ τοῖς ἑλλενοταμίαις ὄντα νῦν.

22. In regard to which there is no evidence, *pace* the view expressed in *ATL* (*supra* n. 8, 327) that it was in the control of the Hellenotamiai; cf. *supra*, n. 21.

23. This is not the place to engage in debate over the date of and connection between these two decrees. I argue elsewhere ("The Kallias Decrees, Thucydides, and the Outbreak of the Peloponnesian War," *CQ*, n.s., 39 [1989], 94–113) that on both epigraphic and historical grounds it is improbable both that the decrees date to 434/3 and that they were passed on the same day. Decree A seems most likely to have been passed in summer 431, and Decree B at some point subsequently. For forceful objections to the date 434/3, see also H. B. Mattingly, "The Financial Decrees of Kallias," *PACA* 7 (1964) 35–55; and C. W. Fornara, "The Date of the Callias Decrees," *GRBS* 11 (1970) 185–96. See also W. K. Pritchett, "Kallias: Fact or Fancy?" *CSCA* 4 (1971) 229–35, and "The Choiseul Marble," *BCH* 10 (1977) 9–10 n. 5, who first raised doubts about the accepted temporal relationship between the two decrees based on examination of the prescript of Decree B.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

ily and solely of tribute, nor that the total was achieved through fifteen 200-talent contributions, completed in 434. There remains to consider a final piece of evidence adduced to support the view that the Hellenotamiai had no reserves of their own because they had systematically given them to Athena.

ATHENIAN EXPENSES FOR THE EXPEDITION AGAINST SAMOS, 441/0, *IG* I³ 363

This inscription, which records the cost of the Athenian operation against Samos in 441/0, suggests that Athena's treasurers alone funded the expedition. On the grounds that this was a League activity and that therefore the Hellenotamiai should have paid for it from League funds, the authors of *ATL* have argued that the Hellenotamiai had no surplus funds in their control in that year. This inference, together with the other documents discussed above, is then generalized to support the view that the Hellenotamiai never possessed a surplus during the period 448–434, that it was instead part of Athena's treasury, and that therefore the Hellenotamiai had no funds with which to meet an emergency or any unanticipated action.[24] It is fair to ask whether this inscription warrants such sweeping conclusions as these. It attests only to the use of Athena's money in this instance, not to a general practice. It does not provide evidence that the League's surplus tribute was located in the treasury of Athena, nor that the Hellenotamiai, as a general rule, had no reserves at their disposal. Further, it is not even certain that Athens regarded, or chose to regard, this enterprise as a League activity. One could imagine that she might not want to antagonize the rest of her allies by spending their money on a campaign against another ally. This, of course, is mere speculation, but the essential point is that one could explain the use of Athena's money here in a number of possible ways without resorting to the conclusions reached in *ATL* from a single specific case. Even if the Hellenotamiai could not meet the cost themselves in this case, for whatever reason, it bears repeating that there is no justification for generalizing to such an extent.

In conclusion, this examination has found nothing to commend the view that the tribute surplus was merged with the treasury of Athena. The hypothesis itself is not impossible, and indeed is attractive, for it seems to make comprehensible a number of documents otherwise troublesome if not chaotic; but there is no direct evidence to warrant its status as fact in modern scholarship. Its appeal, upon examination, is merely specious. We possess insufficient knowledge about the precise amount of funds under the control of the Hellenotamiai; this inadequacy, however, is no reason, in my view, to assume that they had no reserve. Until there is direct evidence to the contrary, it seems best rather to suppose that the Hellenotamiai had charge of the year's tribute *in toto* except for the annual *aparchē* to Athena, as well as the entire tribute reserve. In other words, their function remained the same as it was before the League treasury was moved

24. *ATL* (*supra* n. 8) 327.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

from Delos to Athens, namely, to oversee and administer the funds of the League.

If, then, we reject the theory that the tribute surplus belonged to Athena's treasury, and that therefore the contributions that the treasury made to the Parthenon did *not* consist chiefly of tribute, are we not still left with a contradiction between Plutarch and the Parthenon building accounts? As noted above, the inscriptions indicate that the chief source of income for the project was Athena's treasury, which I have argued did not contain the tribute surplus. On the other hand, Plutarch's account has always convinced those who accepted it that large quantities of tribute were spent on the Parthenon. Indeed, many have accepted not only its authenticity and essential veracity, but even the literal truth of the accusations against Perikles. It is time to reconsider this contradiction.

PLUTARCH, *PERIKLES* 12, AND THE PARTHENON BUILDING ACCOUNTS, *IG* I³ 436–51

Let us begin by examining Plutarch:

> ἡ τῶν ἀναθημάτων κατασκευή, τοῦτο μάλιστα τῶν πολιτευμάτων τοῦ Περικλέους ἐβάσκαινον οἱ ἐχθροὶ καὶ διέβαλλον ἐν ταῖς ἐκκλησίαις, βοῶντες ὡς ὁ μὲν δῆμος ἀδοξεῖ καὶ κακῶς ἀκούει τὰ κοινὰ τῶν Ἑλλήνων χρήματα πρὸς αὑτὸν ἐκ Δήλου μεταγαγών, ἣ δ' ἔνεστιν αὐτῷ πρὸς τοὺς ἐγκαλοῦντας εὐπρεπεστάτη τῶν προφάσεων, δείσαντα τοὺς βαρβάρους ἐκεῖθεν ἀνελέσθαι καὶ φυλάττειν ἐν ὀχυρῷ τὰ κοινά, ταύτην ἀνῄρκε Περικλῆς· καὶ δοκεῖ δεινὴν ὕβριν ἡ Ἑλλὰς ὑβρίζεσθαι καὶ τυραννεῖσθαι περιφανῶς, ὁρῶσα τοῖς εἰσφερομένοις ὑπ' αὐτῆς ἀναγκαίως πρὸς τὸν πόλεμον ἡμᾶς τὴν πόλιν καταχρυσοῦντας καὶ καλλωπίζοντας ὥσπερ ἀλαζόνα γυναῖκα, περιαπτομένην λίθους πολυτελεῖς καὶ ἀγάλματα καὶ ναοὺς χιλιοταλάντους.
>
> (*Per.* 12.1–2)

It has often been supposed that this passage originates from a good contemporary source.[25] Nevertheless, several scholars have questioned its authenticity. Meiggs, for one, notes that the passage may have an "authentic nucleus," but has suffered in the course of transmission, since it contains certain obvious errors

25. E.g., among those who explicitly or implicitly accept the essential historicity of the anecdote in varying degrees, E. Meyer (*supra* n. 2) 86; *Geschichte des Altertums* 4, 5th ed. (Basel, 1956) 690 n. 1; Wade-Gery (*supra* n. 1) 239–70; D. Stockton, "The Peace of Callias," *Historia* 8 (1959) 69; H. D. Meyer, "Thukydides Melesiou und die oligarchische Opposition gegen Perikles," *Historia* 16 (1967) 146–47; K. Meister, "Die Ungeschichtlichkeit des Kalliasfriedens und deren historische Folgen," *Palingenesia* 18 (Wiesbaden, 1982), 35–36; E. Badian, "The Peace of Callias," *JHS* 107 (1987) 19; McGregor (*supra* n. 1).

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

(e.g., that the allies contribute only money, not ships, horses, or hoplites)[26] and anachronisms (the benefits of public works for social and economic welfare are surely a probable one). On the other hand it may be purely an invention of the late fourth century B.C.[27] A. Andrewes has gone farthest in rejecting not only the idea of a contemporary source, good or bad, but even that a historical kernel lies behind the account.[28] He argues rather for a postclassical source to whom the accurate social and political conditions of fifth-century-B.C. Athens were a complete mystery.

One need not go so far as Andrewes in rejecting *Perikles* 11–12 and 14 *in toto;* but it is important to bear in mind that, on any interpretation, this is a tendentious passage full of rhetorical embellishments, preserved in a very late source. Furthermore, although Plutarch often mentions his own source for a particular item of information, in this case he leaves the reader ignorant. One would not be unjustified either in dismissing the passage as untrustworthy or at least in treating it with a healthy skepticism.

In short, objections to Plutarch such as those to which I have alluded are easy to advance. If one rejects Plutarch, then there is no difficulty in reconciling his account with the Parthenon building inscriptions. I wish here, however, to accept the authenticity of Plutarch's account of the building debate (in all degrees, i.e., from a good contemporary source to the existence of a kernel of historical truth contaminated by transmission), because my arguments are addressed to those who do accept the building debate as genuine and think that it provides strong evidence that large amounts of tribute were spent on the Parthenon's construction. The point I wish to argue is simply this: one may accept the essential historicity of the debate and its substance without concluding that it contradicts the implication of the building accounts.

We need to consider the nature of the passage: it is an attack by Perikles' political enemies in public (ἐν ταῖς ἐκκλησίαις, *Per.* 12.1) and as such should be treated with great caution; exaggeration is after all a key weapon of political rhetoric. For example, at the end of section 2, Perikles' enemies claim that allied contributions for the war (πρὸς τὸν πόλεμον) were used to pay for "thousand-talent temples" (ναοὺς χιλιοταλάντους). This was gross exaggeration, and no one today would seriously accept this at face value; the Parthenon, at least, according to R. Stanier in the most comprehensive study on the matter, probably cost between 460 and 500 talents, and it was by far the most expensive of all the

26. Meiggs (*supra* n. 1), *G&R* Suppl. 10, 41–43; cf. also *AE* 139. This view, however, appears to regard errors as a clear sign of subsequent tampering, an opinion easily refuted by reference to, among others, Demosthenes. One should note that, since the point of the accusation clearly concerns tribute first and foremost, the omission of the other forms of obligation is not hard to understand.

27. F. J. Frost, "Pericles, Thucydides, Son of Melesias, and Athenian Politics Before the War," *Historia* 13 (1964) 389–90.

28. A. Andrewes, "The Opposition to Perikles," *JHS* 98 (1978) 1–8; cf. also W. Ameling, "Plutarch, *Perikles* 12–14," *Historia* 34 (1985) 47–63.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

buildings.[29] Scholars rightly recognize and dismiss this as a piece of rhetoric.[30] Yet they treat with no such prudence the charge of extravagant use of tribute. Indeed the entire description of Perikles' building policy is filled with such examples of distortion; in short, it is a fine illustration of its genre, political slander, which we are certainly not to take literally—just as we must take with a grain of salt the claim that the allies furnish neither a horse, nor a ship, nor a hoplite in League campaigns, and that temples cost 1,000 talents, in just the same spirit we must understand what is, after all, only an implication that tribute was the chief source of funding for Perikles' building program. Indeed, for the charge to achieve its intended impact, it is only necessary for *some* allied money to have been spent on the Parthenon, and this is certainly and undeniably true: the Hellenotamiai, as mentioned above, did contribute minor amounts to the building commissioners several times in the course of the temple's construction. Perikles' political enemies could use this fact to political advantage, with the necessary distortion.

The contradiction between Plutarch and the building accounts is therefore, I would argue, only superficial. It is unusual that Plutarch has, in this case, been accepted with surprisingly little question, considering the high degree of skepticism with which he is generally approached. But in any case, *Perikles* 12.2 does not have a greater authority than the Parthenon building accounts and should not compel one to reinterpret them for its sake. I have argued here that, whether one rejects or accepts Plutarch's description of the building debate, there is no reason to suppose that tribute chiefly paid for the Parthenon. Acceptance of *Perikles* 12.2 does not constitute a serious problem for the natural interpretation of the Parthenon accounts.

The Parthenon accounts are not without their own difficulty in interpretation, but this is due more to their state of preservation than to any significant ambiguity. As mentioned above, the chief contributor to the temple's construction was Athena's treasury, and the Hellenotamiai contributed a smaller proportion of the total income at least five times.[31] It is clear from the accounts that the sources of money are listed in order of the size of the contribution; thus, the treasurers of Athena appear at the top of each year's (extant) account, while those contributing minor amounts are listed at the end, such as the *teichopoioi* and *xenodikai*.[32] The Hellenotamiai appear second in the five years in which they occur. But here the uncertainty begins. For only one year, 444/3, do we know how much they contributed, and even for this year the figure is partly restored. Only for one other year, 441/0, is a partial amount preserved (line 177: MM[M---]). Furthermore, often the heading itself is completely restored (e.g., in *IG* I^3

29. R. S. Stanier, "The Cost of the Parthenon," *JHS* 73 (1953) 68–76. That the Parthenon was lavish in scale and cost in comparison with other temples would lend itself to exaggeration.

30. But cf. H. B. Mattingly, "The Athenian Coinage Decree," *Historia* 10 (1961) 166.

31. But note the caution on this statistic in n. 3 *supra*.

32. E.g., *IG* I^3 440, lines 126–27.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

442 line 179, 444 line 247), although these restorations need not be doubted. The largest amount preserved, for 444/3, is, as already mentioned, partly restored. Dinsmoor's restoration, the one generally followed, was made on the basis of the sum that the Hellenotamiai gave to the construction of the Propylaia, $\frac{1}{60}$ of the *phoros* a year. This yields a figure of 42,675$\frac{5}{6}$ drachmai, that is, a little over seven talents.[33] Noting that all other possible restorations hardly approximated $\frac{1}{60}$ of a likely total of tribute, he rejected them.[34]

Dinsmoor's proposed figure may be correct, but it was chosen on what seem to me to be questionable grounds. First, the only similarity between the Parthenon and Propylaia accounts on this matter is the fact that the Hellenotamiai contributed money to both constructions. In the Propylaia accounts, the following specific formula appears in all but one entry for the Hellenotamiai: τοῖ χσυμμαχικοῖ φόρο μνᾶ ἀπὸ τοῖ ταλάντο.[35] In the Parthenon accounts, however, only a figure appears in the left column (or would have appeared, in those cases where that part of the text is not preserved). Given the uncertainty in the actual amount contributed to the temple, it is overly optimistic to assume that it is identical to the amount given in the Propylaia accounts.[36]

Furthermore, although this does not affect the amount of the contribution, the idea that the money given to the construction of both the Parthenon and the Propylaia was the year's *aparchē* to Athena is questionable as well. The entries in the building accounts list the amounts contributed by the Hellenotamiai. Yet the tribute quota lists appear to designate the quota that has already been handed over to the treasurers of Athena and is no longer in the care of the Hellenotamiai. If instead of the quota being dedicated to Athena for these years the equivalent sum had been given directly to the *epistatai* for the building construction, and therefore did not pass into the hands of the treasurers of Athena at all, then we would expect no quota list for these years. Yet we do have lists for these years, and they appear to indicate that, as usual, the treasurers of Athena had received the quota from the Hellenotamiai. If this is indeed the case, then the Hellenotamiai's contributions to the Parthenon were not a given year's *aparchē*.[37] The phrase τοῖ χσυμμαχικοῖ φόρο μνᾶ ἀπὸ τοῖ ταλάντο in the Propylaia accounts need only mean $\frac{1}{60}$ of the annual tribute, another *aparchē,* if one wishes to call it that. There is no evidence that it was Athena's *aparchē.*

33. On this basis Dinsmoor reconstructed the entire tribute for 444/3 to 426 talents, 4,550 drachmai.

34. *Supra* n. 3, 65. Those closest in amount to the one accepted are [MMM[X]] or [[M][X]XX], i.e., 37, 675$\frac{5}{6}$ or 59,675$\frac{5}{6}$ dr.

35. *IG* I^3 462, lines 16–17; *IG* I^3 463, lines 72–73; *IG* I^3 464, lines 110–11; *IG* I^3 465, lines 124–25 (all partially restored); the apparent exception, *IG* I^3 466, in which no trace of the formula appears or has been restored.

36. And therefore possible restorations rejected by Dinsmoor should perhaps not be ruled out.

37. Of course the accumulation of previous years' *aparchai* in Athena's treasury could be considered part of the amount contributed by the treasurers of Athena. This would have been probably in the area of fifty talents by the time construction of the Parthenon was begun.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

One final point needs to be addressed concerning the Parthenon accounts and the tribute. Scholars have long noticed that in the prescript of some of the accounts, the word 'Αθεναίοις appears after the archon date, e.g., ἐπὶ Κράτετος ἄρχοντος 'Αθεναίοισιν (*IG* I³ 449 line 375).[38] The only other place where such a formula appears is in the tribute quota lists.[39] This circumstance has led to the inference that the accounts were published with foreign readership in mind, specifically the Athenian allies, who would require clarification as to whose archon was being mentioned; on this view the accounts would concern them because their tribute was the chief source of funding for the temple.[40]

Several objections may be advanced against this. First, placing 'Αθεναίοις after the archon formula could indicate foreign readership without proving anything about the amount of tribute contributed to the Parthenon. We know that some tribute was used, at least if that is the money contributed by the Hellenotamiai, which is a reasonable assumption.[41] Furthermore, if this formula were for the benefit of the allies, and indicated that the documents concerned them specifically (though not necessarily exclusively), then one would expect to find it in other records concerned with the empire, such as treaties, punitive documents, decrees concerned with reassessments of tribute, and others. In such inscriptions, however, if an archon date appears, it is not followed by the word 'Αθεναίοις.[42] Moreover, the idea that the allies, or any foreigner, needed to be reminded, in Athens and examining an Athenian document, by whose archon the Athenians were dating their documents seems a little odd. Of course this objection applies in any case, and the phrase still demands explanation. But it certainly cannot be considered strong support for the view that tribute chiefly financed the Parthenon.

CONCLUSIONS

One should not take Plutarch, *Perikles* 12.2, as good evidence that a significant quantity of tribute was misappropriated or simply appropriated for the building of the Parthenon. The reason is not, however, that the passage is vague in specific reference, or contains errors and anachronisms, but rather, that it is an obvious example of exaggeration and distortion, the stock-in-trade of political rhetoric. Even if one supposes, as I have here, that the anecdote is authentic,

38. Preserved, at least, only in the later years: 437/6, *IG* I³ 446, line 314; 436/5 (restored), *IG* I³ 447, line 346; 434/3 *IG* I³ 449, line 375; 433/3, *IG* I³ 450, line 417.

39. In the extant fragments it appears in List 1 (454/3) and List 34 (421/0). It has been restored in the Propylaia accounts.

40. This is the view of, among others, P. Foucart, "Les constructions de l'acropole d'après l'*Anonymus Argentinensis*," *RPh* 27 (1903) 10; A. W. Gomme, "Thucydides ii 13, 3," *Historia* 2 (1953/54) 16.

41. See n. 21 *supra*.

42. E.g., *IG* I³ 71, lines 56–57 (425 reassessment decree); *IG* I³ 21, line 61 (decree concerning Miletos); also in the prescript (line 3), there is no room for 'Αθεναίοις.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

and has been accurately preserved from the mid-fifth century B.C. to the late first century A.D., it is evidence only that there was a debate about the use of allied funds on the building program generally, or, more precisely, that Perikles' political enemies attacked him, and one of the arguments used against him was the expenditure of tribute on domestic buildings. It does not provide evidence that tribute was the major source of money for the construction of the Parthenon; all that it need imply at most is that *some* tribute was used, and that this alone provided the historical kernel that was embellished to the extent that we find in *Perikles* 12. In short, Plutarch does not compel us to interpret the building accounts in any way other than the natural and apparent one, that is, that the Hellenotamiai contributed an amount that is substantially unknown, but was certainly much smaller than that contributed by the chief source of funding, money from the treasury of Athena. Perikles' enemies were not successful in their attack; they thought, erroneously, that they could gain politically from the fact that the Hellenotamiai contributed even a modest amount to the temple's construction. Perhaps the truth of the matter forestalled the desired result.

What does this investigation tell us in the end about the financing of the Parthenon? It is my belief, as argued above, that, as the accounts indicate, Athena's treasury was the chief source of income for the Parthenon's construction, but that we should suppose that the treasury did not contain any tribute other than the *aparchē*, $\frac{1}{60}$ of a year's total tribute. It is often contended, however, that without the inclusion of tribute, Athena's treasury would not have contained enough money to expend such a large amount on the temple.[43] But, as A. Burford has noted, the construction of temples was simply not such an expensive operation that, even in the case of the Parthenon, the Athenians needed to resort to allied tribute;[44] this is supported by evidence that temples continued to be built even after the Peloponnesian War began, at Rhamnous, Brauron, and Sounion.[45] Furthermore, there is, in my view, a tendency to underestimate the wealth contained in sacred treasuries in general. For example, even in a much poorer period, the third century B.C., the Athenian Asklepieion contained a surprising amount of sacred property;[46] also, the temple treasures at Selinous in Sicily appear to have been considerable.[47] Neither benefited from tribute.

As for the treasury of Athena, Ferguson and Pritchett have both presented strong arguments that it was much more abundant in the first half of the fifth century than is usually thought, including gifts, fines, confiscations, spoils, rents on sacred land, and war indemnities, all of which would have been accumulating

43. Cf. recently J. W. Roberts, *City of Sokrates* (London, 1984) 187–88.

44. A. Burford, "The Economics of Greek Temple Building," *PCPhS*, n.s., 11 (1965) 26.

45. In support of a date in the 420s for the temple of Nemesis at Rhamnous, see now M. M. Miles, "A Reconstruction of the Temple of Nemesis at Rhamnous," *Hesperia* 58 (1989) 226–35.

46. *IG* II^2 1534A, B, attest to its wealth. I thank Sara Aleshire for bringing this to my attention.

47. Thuc. 6.20; cf. C. Ampolo, "Le riccheze dei Selinuntini: Tucidide VI 20, 4 e l'iscrizione del tempio G di Selinunte," *PP* 215 (1984) 81–89.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press

over the years.[48] Furthermore, I find it hard to believe that the Athenians, in 480, upon evacuating their city, would have left behind all their sacred treasures; these, then, would also figure in the goddess's property.[49] It is also worth remembering that the Athenians actually began work on the original Parthenon in the 480s; this may suggest that they thought that they could pay for a magnificent temple then, before tribute even existed. In addition, the campaigns abroad in the 470s and 460s (e.g., Eurymedon) resulted in large quantities of booty, much of which must have been dedicated to Athena.[50] We should not exclude or overlook other sources of income derived from Athens' hegemonial position, although admittedly most of our evidence for such income as rents on sacred land, tithes, indemnities, and cleruchies is later; it is difficult to believe that such material benefit was wholly absent in the early period of the League.[51]

Finally, what significance do the results of this examination have for our understanding of the Parthenon? The view that the Parthenon is first and foremost a monument of Athenian imperialism (or, I should add, of panhellenism) has always enjoyed ready support and, indeed, confirmation from the belief that the temple was paid for by the enforced contributions of Athens' allies. This study does not necessarily weigh against such an interpretation of the significance of the Parthenon; but what I hope to have demonstrated is that the financing of the Parthenon cannot be used as an argument in its favor, unless one is simply going to base such support upon the contributions of the Hellenotamiai alone. No one would deny that the Athenians in many respects used their hegemony for their own ends; but that everything they undertook in the period of their empire reflects imperial exploitation is clearly untenable.[52]

Smith College

48. W. K. Pritchett, *The Greek State at War*, part 1 (Berkeley and Los Angeles, 1971) 101–4; W. S. Ferguson, "Athenian War Finance," *Proc. Mass. Hist. Soc.* 64 (1930–32) 350–51; *The Treasurers of Athena* (Cambridge, Mass., 1932), 153.

49. The view expressed in *ATL* (*supra* n. 8, 337) that the treasury of Athena was empty in 479, based on the authors' interpretation of Hdt. 8.51, goes back to Beloch, *Griechische Geschichte* II, 2nd ed. (Strassburg, 1916), 324ff. The passage in Herodotos does not compel the view that the men on the Akropolis were guarding the temple treasure. See also B. Jordan, "Servants of the Gods," *Hypomnemata* 55 (1979) 81–84.

50. Cf. Pritchett (*supra* n. 48, 65–68) on booty. It was substantial enough, according to Plutarch (*Kimon* 13), to finance the building of the south wall of the Akropolis; cf. also Paus. 10.15.4, for Athenian dedications at Delphi after Eurymedon, and, in particular, a bronze palm tree topped by a gilded Athena; this gives an indication of the extent of wealth amassed by such a campaign. (I thank Prof. J. Scholten for this reference.)

51. I am not of course arguing that tribute could not be said to be indirectly responsible for such things as the building program; certainly since military expenses were covered largely by tribute, treasuries such as Athena's were available to meet other expenditures.

52. This article is an expanded version of a school paper written at the American School of Classical Studies in Athens in 1986 and of a talk presented at the 1986 annual meeting of the APA. I would like to thank Professors J. McK. Camp, R. S. Stroud, M. M. Miles, and A. Stewart, all of whom kindly consented to read the paper at an earlier stage; Professor R. M. Kallet-Marx for comments and criticisms at every stage; and the anonymous reader.

Copyright (c) 2005 ProQuest Information and Learning Company
Copyright (c) University of California Press